

Checkpoint 3: Game Test Summary

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Game Testers

Adam: Little brother, most familiar with online shooter games and has not played many RPGs before.

Stiehl: Cousin, likes older RPGs like earthbound. Familiar with common RPG tropes.

Bill: Dad, largely unfamiliar with video games. Has some knowledge of mobile games and older arcade games.

Questions

These were live notes that I took while asking them questions.

1.) What were your initial impressions?

Adam: It was different than other games he had played before and was intrigued to how the systems of the game could improve from this point.

Stiehl: He had fun seeing how the game compared to those he had played before and found the music, art and setting charming. However, he thought that some of the bugs in the game detracted slightly from the experience.

Bill: He thought that the game was fun and he wanted to keep playing more so that he could understand more of the game's systems. He also that the music was a good addition to the game level.

2.) What was the most engaging part of the gameplay and why?

Adam: He found the combat to be the most engaging part of the gameplay because it was more high-octane than dungeon exploration.

Stiehl: Also found the combat to be the most engaging part, since he got to make small decisions that altered his strategy.

Bill: He found the exploration and getting the item from the chest to be the most engaging, he found it rewarding to have the character grow stronger.

3.) Were the controls, mechanics and objectives clear to you?

Adam: He looked at the control guide page and was able to understand the controls and objective fine.

Stiehl: Yes, he would feel comfortable playing the game even if the guide was not included in the current state.

Bill: Felt slightly overwhelmed with the amount of choices at the battle screen, and he was not initially aware that the enemy was attacking and dealing damage to him.

4.) How did you feel about the art or music added?

Adam: Liked the sprites that were chosen, especially for the pumpkin enemy.

Stiehl: Liked the main menu video and the music choices that were made in the dungeon and combat.

Bill: Thought the sprites were fun, but found it weird that they were not animated, particularly when the player or enemy attacked.

5.) Did you run into any bugs or other technical issues while playing?

Adam: Did not run into any bugs but noticed that the player was not stopped from attacking while the enemy took their turn in combat.

Stiehl: He walked out of bounds in the main dungeon room while exploring. This bug did not hinder his gameplay experience and

Bill: He noticed that when he opened the chest he was teleported to the middle of the room. This turned out to be a result of the saving system not saving the players position outside of the chest and instead placing them in the initial starting position.

6.) Do you have any suggestions for things to add to the game?

Adam: Add additional UI elements like health bars and a menu button to go to the pause menu. He also suggested making enemies move in the dungeon so that you could dodge them to avoid combat.

Stiehl: Suggested a system for selecting different attack loadouts in combat, like classes and such. Also consider implementing enemy weaknesses for players to exploit. Finally, he suggested an interact system where players could interact with an object and the world and be presented with text describing the object.

Bill: Add animations for walking and attacking in combat. He also wanted more dungeon rooms to be included in the game.

Summary

Self Summary

While many were intrigued by the game concepts and had fun playing through the current section, there were some clearly incomplete portions of the game that could be improved upon. These can include wall collisions, saving system, and the timing of attacks in the battle system. However, many of them liked the implementation of the sprites and other media that were placed into the game, and those who were unfamiliar with RPGs and other games had little issue figuring out the controls and the objective. Overall, they agree that the current state of the game, with some minor tweaks and bug fixes, is a solid foundation for more enemies and battle mechanics to be implemented.

Group Summary

Across all of the testers, many of them said that the media used in the game was their favorite part and meaningfully added to the experience. Although, many of them also found bugs in their work that would need to be patched out, such as unexpected behavior from game objects and issues with saving the player's position. Many suggestions that were made by those who played the game matched initiatives that we already had planned, such as introducing more rooms, attacks, enemies, and animations, along with the bug fixes. Some focuses of interviews differed from mine, such as Clayton's where he asked what price players would pay for a finished game, to which many responded a lower price like \$10. Overall, many of the game testers came to the conclusion that the game had an interesting and solid base with good media implementation and easy controls, but still needed some bug fixes and complete mechanics.

AI: N/A